DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

IN TODAY'S RAPIDLY CHANGING DIGITAL WORLD, DIGITAL LITERACY IS A NECESSARY SKILL FOR STUDENTS. IT NOW GOES BEYOND BASIC COMPUTER KNOWLEDGE. IT INCLUDES CREATING A PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE, COMMUNICATING WELL, AND STAYING SAFE IN THE DIGITAL SPACE. AS A STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR, MY JOB IS TO HELP MY PEERS NAVIGATE THIS DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT RESPONSIBLY AND EFFECTIVELY. THIS PORTFOLIO REFLECTS MY UNDERSTANDING AND USE OF IMPORTANT DIGITAL SKILLS. THROUGH A SERIES OF PRACTICAL TASKS, I EXPLORED TOOLS, PLATFORMS, AND BEST PRACTICES THAT ARE VITAL FOR ACADEMIC GROWTH AND FUTURE CAREER OPPORTUNITIES. EACH TASK FOCUSES ON A DIFFERENT ASPECT OF DIGITAL LITERACY, COVERING AWARENESS, PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING, CYBERSECURITY, AND COMMUNICATION ETIQUETTE.

TASK- 1

FOR THIS TASK, I DESIGNED A ONE-PAGE INFOGRAPHIC TO EXPLAIN DIGITAL LITERACY AND ITS IMPORTANCE FOR STUDENTS. I USED CANVA TO CREATE THE VISUAL BECAUSE IT OFFERS A VARIETY OF TEMPLATES, ICONS, AND DESIGN ELEMENTS THAT MAKE INFORMATION ENGAGING AND EASY TO UNDERSTAND.

THE INFOGRAPHIC IS DIVIDED INTO THREE MAIN SECTIONS. THE FIRST SECTION DEFINES DIGITAL LITERACY AS THE ABILITY TO FIND, EVALUATE, CREATE, AND COMMUNICATE INFORMATION USING DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES. THE SECOND SECTION HIGHLIGHTS USEFUL DIGITAL TOOLS FOR STUDENTS, INCLUDING DIGITAL PLANNERS FOR ORGANIZING TASKS, SCHEDULING APPS FOR TIME MANAGEMENT, AND RELIABLE ONLINE SOURCES FOR RESEARCH.

TASK- 1

THE FINAL SECTION FOCUSES ON SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES, SUCH AS KEEPING PASSWORDS PRIVATE, AVOIDING SUSPICIOUS LINKS, AND BEING KIND AND RESPONSIBLE WHILE INTERACTING ONLINE.

ONE CHALLENGE I FACED WHEN CREATING THIS INFOGRAPHIC WAS ORGANIZING THE CONTENT IN A VISUALLY APPEALING YET SIMPLE WAY WITHOUT OVERCROWDING THE DESIGN. I FOUND IT INTERESTING HOW VISUALS AND ICONS CAN MAKE COMPLEX IDEAS EASIER TO GRASP AND MORE ENGAGING FOR VIEWERS.

TASK- 2

IN THIS TASK, I CREATED AND UPDATED MY PROFILES ON THREE IMPORTANT PLATFORMS: GITHUB, LINKEDIN, AND KAGGLE.
EACH OF THESE PLATFORMS SERVES A UNIQUE PURPOSE IN BUILDING A STRONG PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY ONLINE.
GITHUB IS MAINLY USED FOR HOSTING AND SHOWCASING CODING PROJECTS, ALLOWING DEVELOPERS TO COLLABORATE AND MANAGE VERSION CONTROL.
LINKEDIN IS A PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING SITE WHERE STUDENTS CAN CONNECT WITH PEERS, PROFESSORS, AND INDUSTRY PROFESSIONALS WHILE SHARING THEIR ACHIEVEMENTS AND EXPERIENCES.
KAGGLE FOCUSES ON DATA SCIENCE AND MACHINE LEARNING, WHERE USERS CAN PRACTICE WITH REAL DATASETS, PARTICIPATE IN COMPETITIONS, AND LEARN THROUGH COMMUNITY-SHARED NOTEBOOKS.

TASK- 2

SETTING UP THESE PROFILES HELPED ME REALIZE THE IMPORTANCE OF MAINTAINING A CONSISTENT AND PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE. I INCLUDED BASIC DETAILS LIKE MY ACADEMIC BACKGROUND, SKILLS, AND INTERESTS. OVER THE NEXT FOUR YEARS, I PLAN TO UPDATE THESE PLATFORMS REGULARLY BY UPLOADING PROJECTS ON GITHUB, ENGAGING WITH PROFESSIONAL CONTENT ON LINKEDIN, AND PRACTICING DATA-RELATED PROBLEMS ON KAGGLE. THIS TASK MADE ME SEE THAT A STRONG DIGITAL PRESENCE NOT ONLY REFLECTS MY SKILLS BUT ALSO INCREASES MY VISIBILITY TO RECRUITERS AND INTERNSHIP COORDINATORS. IT IS A VITAL STEP IN BUILDING A SUCCESSFUL ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY.

TASK- 3

IN THIS TASK, I EXPLORED CODING PRACTICE AND COLLABORATION TOOLS BY CREATING AN ACCOUNT ON HACKERRANK AND COMPLETING THE BEGINNER-LEVEL CHALLENGE CALLED “SOLVE ME FIRST.” HACKERRANK IS A POPULAR PLATFORM THAT HELPS STUDENTS IMPROVE THEIR PROGRAMMING AND PROBLEM-SOLVING SKILLS THROUGH STRUCTURED CHALLENGES AND REAL-WORLD CODING PROBLEMS. THE “SOLVE ME FIRST” CHALLENGE REQUIRED ME TO WRITE SIMPLE PROGRAMS SUCH AS TAKING TWO INTEGERS AS INPUT AND OUTPUTS THEIR SUM. EVEN THOUGH THE PROBLEM WAS BASIC, IT TAUGHT ME HOW TO WORK WITH INPUT AND OUTPUT IN A CODING ENVIRONMENT, FOLLOW PROBLEM INSTRUCTIONS CLOSELY, AND SUBMIT SOLUTIONS IN THE CORRECT FORMAT.

TASK- 3

IT ALSO INTRODUCED ME TO HOW CODING PLATFORMS AUTOMATICALLY ASSESS SOLUTIONS, WHICH WAS A NEW AND INTERESTING EXPERIENCE. ADDITIONALLY, I CREATED A GOOGLE FORM WITH FIVE QUESTIONS TO ASSESS DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS AMONG MY PEERS. THE FORM INCLUDED BOTH MULTIPLE-CHOICE AND SHORT-ANSWER QUESTIONS, MAKING IT INTERACTIVE AND INFORMATIVE. THIS TASK WAS HELPFUL IN STRENGTHENING MY FOUNDATIONAL CODING SKILLS AND BOOSTING MY CONFIDENCE IN USING ONLINE PLATFORMS FOR LEARNING. HACKERRANK WILL ALLOW ME TO PRACTICE MORE COMPLEX PROBLEMS OVER TIME, WHILE TOOLS LIKE GOOGLE FORMS WILL AID DATA COLLECTION AND COLLABORATION IN ACADEMIC PROJECTS.

TASK- 4

THIS TASK FOCUSED ON DEVELOPING EFFECTIVE DIGITAL COMMUNICATION SKILLS. I DRAFTED TWO FORMAL EMAILS—ONE ASKING FOR AN EXTENSION ON AN ASSIGNMENT AND ANOTHER EXPRESSING INTEREST IN A SUMMER INTERNSHIP. WHILE WRITING THESE EMAILS, I FOLLOWED PROPER EMAIL ETIQUETTE. I USED CLEAR AND RELEVANT SUBJECT LINES, MAINTAINED A POLITE TONE, STRUCTURED THE CONTENT LOGICALLY, AND ENDED WITH A FORMAL CLOSING. THIS EXERCISE HELPED ME UNDERSTAND HOW PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION DIFFERS FROM CASUAL MESSAGING AND WHY CLARITY AND TONE MATTER. IN ADDITION TO EMAIL WRITING, I CREATED A CHECKLIST OF DO'S AND DON’TS FOR RESPONSIBLE SOCIAL MEDIA USE AS A COLLEGE STUDENT. THIS CHECKLIST HIGHLIGHTS MAINTAINING A POSITIVE DIGITAL FOOTPRINT, BEING RESPECTFUL IN ONLINE INTERACTIONS, PROTECTING PERSONAL INFORMATION, AND AVOIDING HARMFUL OR INAPPROPRIATE CONTENT.

TASK- 4

ONE SITUATION WHERE POOR DIGITAL COMMUNICATION CAN CAUSE PROBLEMS IS WHEN A STUDENT SENDS AN UNCLEAR OR UNPROFESSIONAL EMAIL TO A PROFESSOR OR RECRUITER, WHICH MAY LEAD TO MISUNDERSTANDINGS OR MISSED OPPORTUNITIES. FOR INSTANCE, A VAGUE SUBJECT LINE OR DISRESPECTFUL TONE COULD RESULT IN THE EMAIL BEING OVERLOOKED. FOLLOWING PROPER COMMUNICATION GUIDELINES, BEING CLEAR AND CONCISE, AND MAINTAINING PROFESSIONALISM CAN HELP AVOID SUCH SITUATIONS. OVERALL, THIS TASK HELPED ME IMPROVE BOTH MY COMMUNICATION SKILLS AND MY AWARENESS OF RESPONSIBLE BEHAVIOR ONLINE.

TASK- 5

IN THIS TASK, I RESEARCHED PHISHING AS A COMMON TYPE OF CYBERCRIME AND STUDIED THE REAL-LIFE CASE KNOWN AS THE 2016 GOOGLE & FACEBOOK INVOICE SCAM. PHISHING IS A CYBERATTACK WHERE CRIMINALS PRETEND TO BE TRUSTED ORGANIZATIONS OR PEOPLE TO TRICK VICTIMS INTO SHARING SENSITIVE INFORMATION OR SENDING MONEY. THIS CASE SHOWS HOW PHISHING RELIES MORE ON HUMAN TRUST THAN ON TECHNICAL WEAKNESSES. THE SCAM WAS CARRIED OUT BY EVALDAS RIMASAUSKAS, WHO CREATED A FAKE COMPANY WITH THE SAME NAME AS A LEGITIMATE SUPPLIER USED BY GOOGLE AND FACEBOOK. HE SENT FRAUDULENT EMAILS ALONG WITH FORGED INVOICES AND CONTRACTS THAT LOOKED AUTHENTIC

TASK- 5

AS A RESULT, EMPLOYEES FROM THE FINANCE DEPARTMENTS OF BOTH COMPANIES UNKNOWINGLY TRANSFERRED OVER $100 MILLION TO HIS ACCOUNTS. THE MONEY WAS THEN SPREAD ACROSS MULTIPLE INTERNATIONAL BANKS TO AVOID DETECTION. WHAT SURPRISED ME MOST WAS THAT EVEN LARGE, TECHNOLOGICALLY ADVANCED COMPANIES COULD FALL VICTIM TO SUCH A SCAM, SHOWING THAT ANYONE CAN BE TARGETED. THIS HAS MADE ME MORE CAREFUL ABOUT VERIFYING EMAILS AND FINANCIAL REQUESTS. NOW, I WILL ALWAYS DOUBLE-CHECK PAYMENT REQUESTS FOR AUTHENTICITY AND AVOID TRUSTING EMAILS WITHOUT PROPER VERIFICATION.

CONCLUSION

THIS DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO HAS HELPED ME GAIN A DEEPER UNDERSTANDING OF THE SKILLS NEEDED TO NAVIGATE THE DIGITAL WORLD EFFECTIVELY. FROM CREATING PROFESSIONAL PROFILES TO ENSURING ONLINE SAFETY AND PRACTICING ETHICAL COMMUNICATION, EACH TASK HAS BUILT MY CONFIDENCE AS A RESPONSIBLE DIGITAL USER. AS A STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR, I NOW FEEL MORE PREPARED TO HELP MY PEERS AND PROMOTE SAFE AND PRODUCTIVE DIGITAL PRACTICES. THESE SKILLS WILL SUPPORT MY ACADEMIC JOURNEY AND PLAY AN IMPORTANT ROLE IN MY FUTURE CAREER.